

Tabloid TECH

People And Events That Grabbed The Headlines—For Better Or For Worse

Play The Movie!

Haven't we told you about movies being made from games and vice versa? Somehow, either both the concepts just don't appeal or weren't given proper treatment. Heard of Uwe Boll? Doesn't that name sound familiar to you? He's the German director, producer and screenwriter who makes movies based on popular video games.

This reminds us of *Doom*. But no, Boll is more interested in gory games like *House of Dead*, *Alone in the Dark*,

BloodRayne, and more. Reports indicate that there are over 200,000 petitions filed online against him, all complaining so that he may just *stop* making movies! But does Boll feel the lesser itch? No, because he's absolutely in love with the video game industry.

Recently, he was eyeing *World of Warcraft* and intended to make a movie on it. When he got in touch with Paul Sams of Blizzard, he got a very clear signal—"We will not sell the movie rights, not to you...especially not to you."

Hey John, It's me!

When was the last time you sent a bug report and got a reply? Can't recollect? Well, try sending one for Safari or any other bug report to Apple Inc., using John Mayer as the lucky mascot. You'll get a reply for sure. Last month when John Mayer blogged about the bug report on crashing iTunes, he mentioned about his long wait for a response.

Mayer happens to be the gig boy for Apple, since he performs a guitar gig sometimes at the Apple events. He also happens to be Mr. Job's favourite poster boy. But has anyone heard from Apple as yet, on the crash report submitted for the Mac OS X? Following this, a guest editor at popular Web site Gizmodo, sent hundreds of bug reports but didn't receive *any* reply from Apple.

After reading about John Mayer's problem, he wrote crash reports and added "John Mayer here" in the report, and waited with fingers crossed. He also mentioned that John Mayer gets personalised replies from Apple. To his surprise he got a mail



from Apple Support, asking details about his PC's hardware configuration and OS.

Hence, it is obviously proved that using the "John Mayer here" trick obviously works. So the next time if you have any crash reports with iTunes or Safari for Windows, then do try this gig. It doesn't matter if John Mayer knows you personally or not, but it does matter that you know who John Mayer is!

Madonna sleeps with her Blackberry



We all know that technology at times becomes so addictive, that resisting it, is at times, next to impossible. Be it surfing the Web or using gadgets, the addiction turns into an obsession which can get really serious. In an interview with a popular lifestyle magazine, Madonna spoke about life in general and her relationship with husband Guy Ritchie.

While talking about dilly-dally things in her life, Madonna revealed that every night "she sleeps with her blackberry". Well to be specific, she keeps the blackberry under the pillow. While she gets ready for bed, her husband plays *Brick* on the phone. And how does she use Blackberry? In the middle of the night, if she happens to recollect something that she missed out on, then she notes it as a message on her Blackberry.

Well, with all those occasional and supposedly private India tours that Madonna undertakes, Research in Motion should consider signing her up as a brand ambassador—especially with all the security hype over the Blackberry in India.

Caution...Election

Nothing can be so embarrassing for a Web site programmer, than writing poor HTML code. What would you do if you land up in the midst of the free way to the US elections? Hmm... it's going to be tough for you to decide on whom to go for—Obama or Hillary.

Nothing bothers a candidate more than a goof up during campaigning. Probably, that's why Obama appeared gloomy, the past few days when visitors got redirected to his opponent Hillary Clinton's site! On one fine Saturday, the visitors at Obama's community blogs section of the site were redirected to Hillary's site.

Later it was discovered, that a person with user name "Mox" had planted the hack for HTML exploit, due to cross-site scripting vulnerability. Another user named "Zennie62" posted this hack video on YouTube, which was later fixed.

Now if Obama is campaigning for such a high position, these silly and common exploits can make quite a few giggle. When small time hackers like Mox can take a dig at his site, what would happen if Hillary hires a gang of hackers!

Soon after the exploit was fixed, Mox sent out an email to a news site, informing that his action was mere "prank" meant for fun. He wasn't politically motivated and Clinton had no hands behind the prank. Mr. Senator Obama, hope you heard that, and your tech team might've heaved a sigh of relief. But be prepared for who knows, a team of liberal hackers may gang up against you. This is politics, dirty politics!